

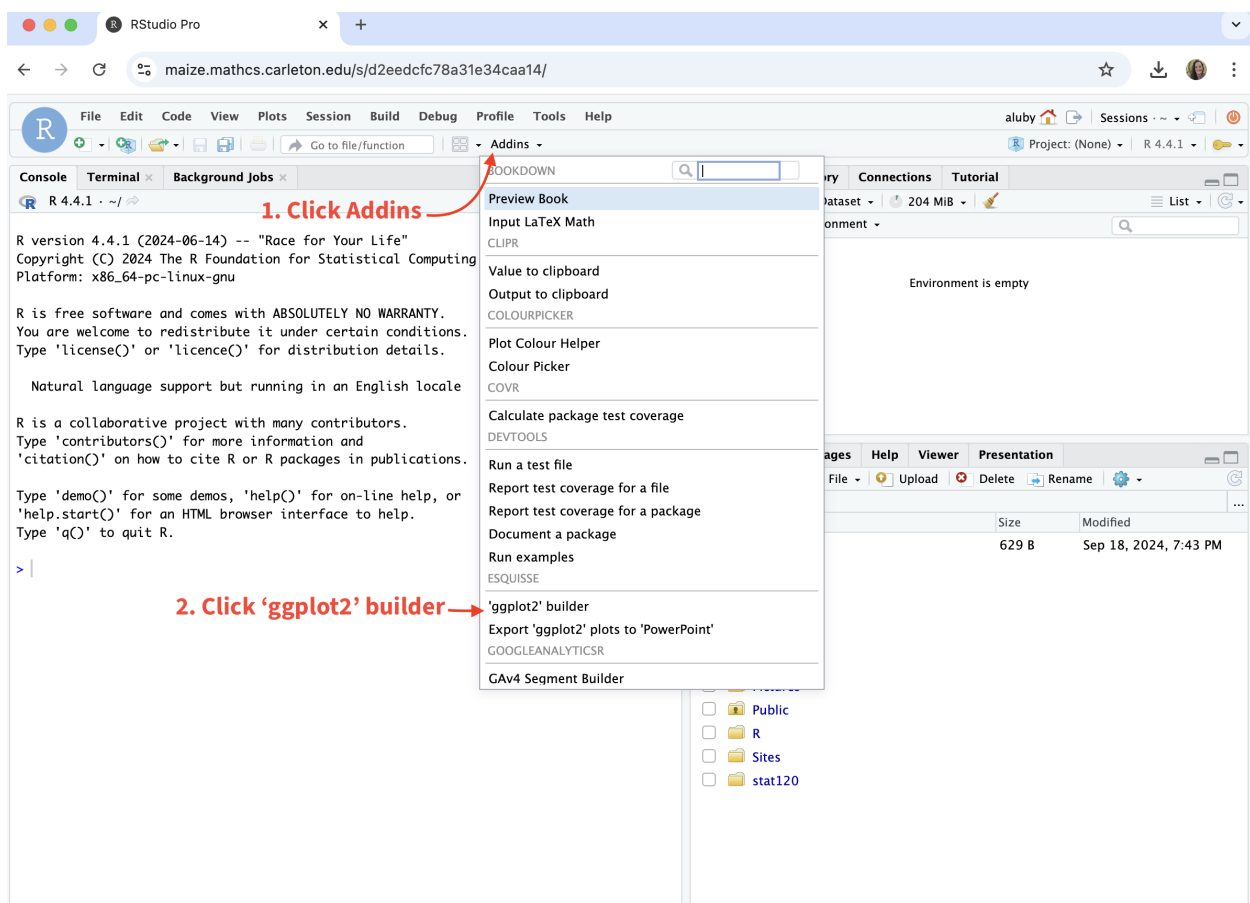
A BRIEF INTRO TO R

Stat 120 | Spring 2026 | Background Readings
Prof Amanda Luby

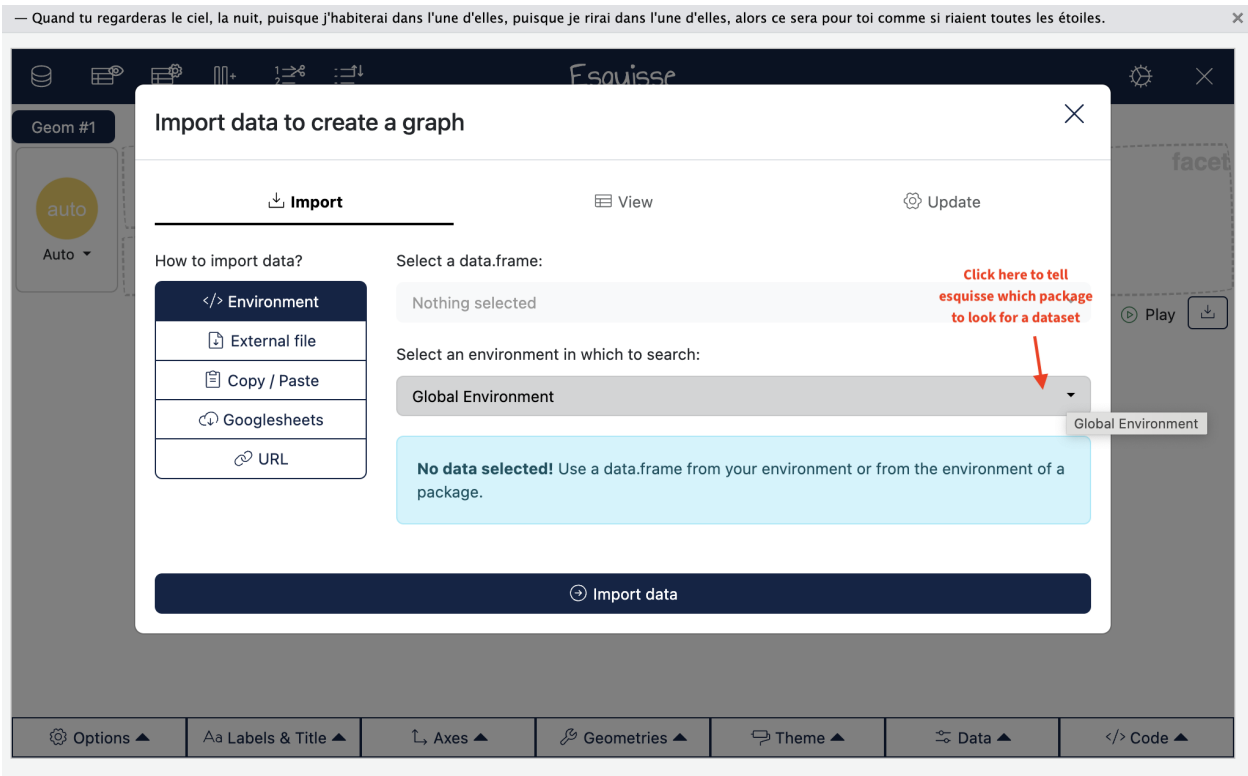
There are **lots** of different ways to make plots in R/RStudio. If you're reading the R manual, you'll see some code that uses base R for graphics and other code that uses `ggplot2` for graphics. I prefer `ggplot2` because I find the logic more consistent and the default graphs more visually appealing, so most of my example code will use `ggplot2` syntax.

We're also going to use the `esquisse` package to get familiar with the syntax for making graphs and be able to play around with different graphics options without using code.

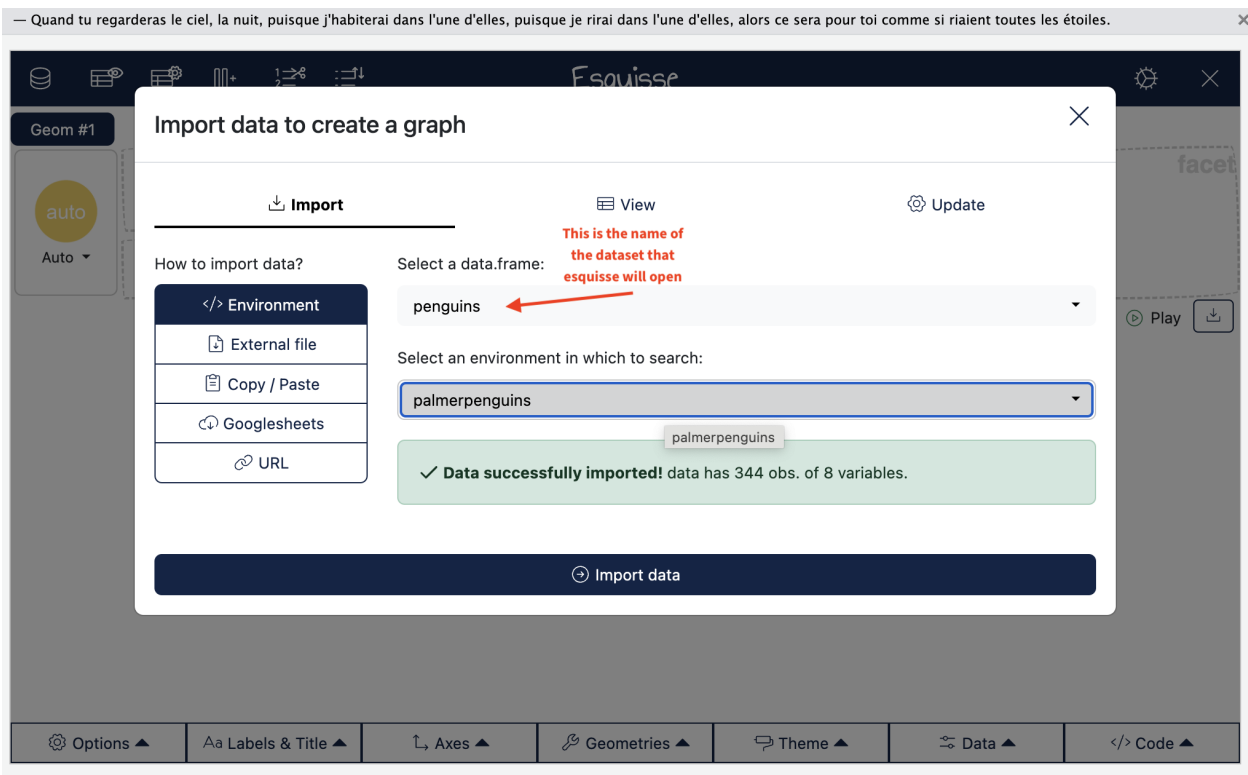
To access it, click “addins” and then “ggplot2 builder”



It might take a few moments, but the following window should open up. `esquisse` is able to see any data that you have loaded in your R environment. Since I don't have any data loaded in, I have to tell it where to look. Type `palmerpenguins` in the “Select an environment in which to search” menu.



Now we can choose a dataset to open up with esquisse. Penguins should appear in the menu, then click “import data”



When the data is loaded, you should see the menu below. Each of the variables appears as a colored box

The screenshot shows the Esquisse application interface. At the top, there is a dark blue header bar with the title "Esquisse" and a close button. Below the header, there is a row of tabs labeled "Geom #1" through "Geom #8". The "Geom #1" tab is selected, showing a list of layers: "auto", "Aa species", "Aa island", "# bill_length_mm", "# bill_depth_mm", "# flipper_length_mm", "# body_mass_g", and "# year". The "Aa species" layer is selected, and its properties are shown in the "Aa Labels & Title" panel. The "Aa species" layer is a scatter plot with "species" on the x-axis and "bill_length_mm" on the y-axis. The plot is faceted by "island". The "Aa species" layer is a scatter plot with "species" on the x-axis and "bill_length_mm" on the y-axis. The plot is faceted by "island". The "Aa species" layer is a scatter plot with "species" on the x-axis and "bill_length_mm" on the y-axis. The plot is faceted by "island".



That's all! We'll get some practice using `esquisse` and `ggplot2` in class.